

How to use this book

An atlas usually shows maps of different countries, but animals often live across borders. The maps in this book show many of the world's different habitats, which is the environment where an animal lives, such as a desert. Some islands are also shown, since they have animals that are found nowhere else.

Compass

The compass always points north (N) in line with the map. It also shows the direction of south (S), east (E), and west (W).

Animal pictures

Pictures with descriptions pick out particular animals that live in an area.

Independent states

Small independent states, such as Monaco, are shown with a red border and a solid red dot, and the name is in capital letters.

Rivers

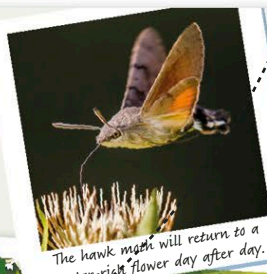
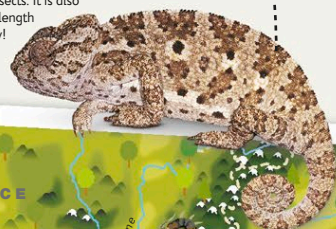
Each country's largest rivers are shown as continuous blue lines.

Mediterranean scrubland

The coastal areas around the Mediterranean Sea contain rocky hills and flat, shrub-filled plains. This rare habitat is found in only a few places on Earth. Plants here can survive wildfires, and animals have to deal with hot, dry weather.

Mediterranean chameleon

This is one of only two chameleon species found in Europe. Its tongue is sticky to catch passing insects. It is also twice the length of its body!



Hummingbird hawk moth

This insect beats its wings so fast that they make a humming sound—just like the birds it's named after. It feeds on nectar made by flowers like buddleia and honeysuckle.

Iberian lynx

Just 404 adult Iberian lynxes are left in the wild, so this is the most endangered cat on Earth—but the good news is this figure is nearly twice the number of wild lynxes alive a few years ago!



The Iberian lynx mostly hunts just one animal—the European rabbit.



Capital

A country's capital city is marked with a red outline. Some countries have more than one capital city.

Scale

The scale shows the size of the areas and the distances between different points on the map.

Location

The location box shows you where each area is found in relation to the land around it.

Habitat key

Every map has a key that lists the types of habitats found in that area.

Bordering continents

Around the edges of some maps you can see parts of bordering continents in a cream color.